DAILY READER

PARSHAT LECH LECHA

The parting of Abram and Lot — and what of the sacred may be sold

Tuesday, 20 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 13:5-13:18) · Daf Bekhorot 32

Yesterday's daf was Bekhorot 31 — in one sentence, what was it about?

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

None of the linked sources scored as illuminating

Jev score: 0.43 — Jev scored 10 linked sources (verses, the Bekhorot intro essay, two Noda BiYehudah responsa) on whether each illuminates the daf non-obviously, beyond merely being cited by it.

Jev was unmoved by all ten: the top score was 0.43 for the Bekhorot introduction essay, and even that fell well short of a genuine illumination. The verses the daf cites — Leviticus 27:28 (dedications), 27:33 (the animal tithe), Numbers 18:17 (the firstborn), Deuteronomy 12:15 (the orphans' tithe meat) — all scored between 0.16 and 0.35: they are the daf's raw material, not its commentary. The two Noda BiYehudah responsa (0.26, 0.36) apply the sugya rather than lighting it.

That is itself a finding about this daf. Bekhorot 32 is a closed hermeneutic system — gezerah shavah built on gezerah shavah, each analogy's validity hinging on whether a phrase is 'free' — and the linked sources are mostly the verses being analogized. The illumination, if there is any, lives inside the argument's own machinery, not in an outside text.

Rejected by Jev: Lev 27:28 (0.16), Lev 27:33 (0.16), Num 18:17 (0.23), Deut 12:15 (0.33), Ex 13:12 (0.35), Lev 14:39/44 (0.26/0.28), Noda BiYehudah YD 196:7 (0.26), YD 195:3 (0.36), Bekhorot intro essay (0.43).

PARSHA · LECH LECHA

The tithe Abraham gave, and the tithe that cannot be sold

Jev score: 0.44 — Jev scored 7 candidate connections between the daf's themes and Lech Lecha on how strongly each is grounded in the actual texts versus a stretch.

The best of a weak field (0.44): Abraham gives Melchizedek 'a tenth of everything' (Gen 14:20) — a tithe surrendered to the priest of God Most High — while the daf obsesses over the animal tithe and precisely when its meat may or may not be sold. Both texts circle the same question: what portion of one's property is set apart as sacred, and what can then be done with it.

The rest did not survive Jev's strictness: Abraham's refusal of Sodom's spoils (0.35), the gezerah-shavah/divine-speech parallel (0.37), the herders' quarrel as local custom (0.22), the covenant between the pieces (0.25), the blessing motif (0.12), Pharaoh's livestock gifts (0.20). An honest week: the daf and the parsha are ships passing — one in the Temple's accounting office, the other on the road to Canaan.

Rejected by Jev: Sodom spoils (0.35), wording-as-law (0.37), herders/minhag (0.22), brit bein habetarim (0.25), blessing motif (0.12), Pharaoh's herds (0.20).

NEWS CHECK

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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No meaningful resonance this week

Jev score: 0.35 — Jev scored 8 of the week's biggest stories against the daf's themes, instructed to be strict: a shared single word is not a connection.

Nothing cleared the bar. The least-forced candidate — sanctioned oil that the world needs but cannot freely trade, echoing the animal tithe's trapped non-market status — managed only 0.35. France's riots as 'local custom filling the vacuum' scored 0.30; the Ukraine drone barrage and the WFP's Gaza aid cuts, both proposed with straight faces, scored 0.20 and 0.07. The rest (Pakistan-Afghanistan clashes, the Canadian base fire, Trump's polling, the typhoon) were scored at or near zero.

Jev's verdict is worth printing plainly: a daf about the saleability of consecrated animals and the mechanics of verbal analogy does not, this week, illuminate the news — and the news does not illuminate it. Forced resonance would be the real failure.

MAAGARIM · GEULAH

גאלה: 1,381 attestations, from land-buyback to national redemption

גאלה opens in Leviticus 25 as land law — 'גאלה תתנו לארץ': redemption as the buyback of sold family land, a property mechanism with a price and a deadline. Maagarim's 1,195 citations across 60 pages trace its long climb out of the ledger.

By the Great Revolt it is stamped on coins — 'לגאלת ציון' — and written into Judean Desert sale deeds of 67–69: redemption of Zion as a political slogan, not a transaction. The medieval cluster shows it in geonic responsa pleading for ransom-of-captives funds, in Passover and Sukkot piyyutim, and in Golden Age Spanish verse (Shmuel HaNagid, Ibn Khalfoun) as eschatological hope. It lands in Bialik — a world 'הטעון גאולה, בינוס, סדור' (1933): national redemption as a cultural program. From a buyback clause to the vocabulary of Zionism — the daf's fine distinction between גאולה and פדיון sits at the foot of a two-thousand-year semantic ascent.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית *— the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.*

929 · I KINGS 11 (CH. 298)

The hinge: Solomon's heart turns, the kingdom tears

43 verses

Solomon's last chapter. After the glory of chs. 9-10 (dedication prayer, the queen of Sheba), ch. 11 is the hinge on which the whole book turns: the kingdom Solomon built fractures in

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his own lifetime's aftermath. The chapter moves in four movements — the wives (1-8), the adversaries (14-25), Ahijah's acted prophecy (26-40), death (41-43).

The chapter's repeated Hebrew keyword is לב/לבבו ("his heart"): "נשיו הטו את לבבו שלם" (v.4), "ולא היה לבבו" (v.4), "וילך שלמה אחרי עשתרת" (v.5). The heart that asked for wisdom (3:9) is now tilted (נטה) by love. Malbim reads the sin as triple: foreign wives (not "taking a wife" but a youth's consuming passion — "דבק שלמה לאהבה"), the Torah's ban on intermarriage, and multiplying wives against the king's law — and Radak adds the tragic irony that Solomon trusted his own wisdom ("אל יתהלל חכם בחכמתו").

Ralbag insists on a precise, almost legal reading: Solomon did not himself worship idols. After stating that his wives turned his heart, Scripture need not add "ולא היה לבבו שלם" — the point is that his love made him connive: he let them worship and "closed his eyes" (עיניו העלים). "וילך שלמה אחרי עשתרת" means he permitted his Sidonian and Ammonite wives their gods. The sin is tolerance-as-betrayal.

God "raises up" (ויקם ה' שטן) Hadad the Edomite and Rezon of Damascus — adversaries whose biographies mirror Solomon's own rise (Hadad flees as a boy, marries into Pharaoh's house, returns; Rezon gathers men, takes Damascus). The empire's edges peel away first: the chapter's geography (Edom south, Aram north) is the unmaking of chs. 4-5's "from Dan to Beersheba" dominion.

The chapter's narrative pivot is a prophetic street-theater: Ahijah tears his new cloak into twelve pieces and gives ten to Jeroboam (29-31). Metzudat David counts the arithmetic (twelve tears, thirteen pieces, ten tears to Jeroboam for ten tribes). Malbim's gem: a prophecy accompanied by a physical act is irrevocable — "עמה איזה פעולה היא מוכרחת להתקיים דבר הנבואה שתבא" — sealed even against Solomon's repentance. The torn garment is the torn kingdom made visible.

Why is the kingdom torn only after Solomon's death, though he was the sinner? Malbim's answer is structural: the Davidic promise had two tiers — "לדוד אמת לא ישוב ממנה' נשבע ה" unconditional for Solomon himself, conditional ("אם ישמרו בניך בריתי") for his descendants. So "אך בימיך לא אעשנה" — the tearing waits for Rehoboam. One tribe remains "ולמען ירושלם למען דוד עבדי" (v.13): Rashi hears in "אך לא כל הימים" (v.39) the messianic reversal, when the kingdom returns to David's house.

I Kings 11 is the book's first great reversal — the hinge between the united monarchy and the divided one, between Solomon the builder and Jeroboam the divider. Everything after (the schism, the northern kingdom's calf cults) is the long working-out of Ahijah's torn cloak. The chapter also closes the Deuteronomistic warning of Deut 17:17 ("לא ירבה לו נשים") — the one law written specifically for kings is the one the wisest king breaks.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 11:4-5

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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The man in the window and the law of fear

2 mishnayot

Oholot 11:4

הָיָה מַשְׁקִיף בְּעַד הַחַלּוֹן וְהֶאֱהִיל עַל קוֹבְרֵי הַמֵּת, בֵּית שַׁמַּאי אוֹמְרִים, אֵינוֹ מֵבִיא אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה. וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים, מֵבִיא אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה. וּמוֹדִים, שֶׁאִם הָיָה לָבוּשׁ בְּכֵלָיו, אוֹ שֶׁהָיוּ שְׁנַיִם זֶה עַל גַּבֵּי זֶה, שֶׁהֵם מְבִיאִין אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה:

If a person was looking out of a window and overshadowed a funeral procession: Bet Shammai says: he does not bring uncleanness. But Bet Hillel says: he does bring the uncleanness. They agree that if he was dressed in his clothes or if there were two persons, one above the other, they bring the uncleanness.

Rambam: 'קוברי המת' means the bearers — until the corpse itself overshadows the object does it count as a tent; 'bringing the impurity' here means bringing it into the house he looks out from, defiling that house. Bet Hillel's reason: a man counts as hollow, so his upper side brings the impurity — like a tent, part over the corpse and part inside the house, with a handbreadth or more between his body and the tent, because man is hollow.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: The bearers pass beneath the window while the man overshadows them. Bet Shammai: no handbreadth of air between the man and the sill, so no tent. Bet Hillel: the man 'counts as hollow.' Strikingly, even Bet Shammai concede the clothed man or the two-stacked-men cases — the garment counts as a tent hovering a handbreadth above the wearer. Mishnat Eretz Yisrael reads this as the dialogue between law and the psychology of fear: in the core halakhah the legal side won, in the secondary halakhah psychology won — both ancient, neither prior to the other.

Oholot 11:5

הָיָה מֻטָּל עַל הָאַסְקֻפָּה וְהֶאֱהִילוּ עָלָיו קוֹבְרֵי הַמֵּת, בֵּית שַׁמַּאי אוֹמְרִים, אֵינוֹ מֵבִיא אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה. וּבֵית הִלֵּל אוֹמְרִים, מֵבִיא אֶת הַטֻּמְאָה:

If a person was lying on the threshold and the funeral procession overshadowed him: Bet Shammai says: he does not bring uncleanness. But Bet Hillel says: he does bring the uncleanness.

Rambam: he lies with part of him in the house and part on the threshold; Bet Hillel hold to their view that man is hollow, so he brings the impurity into the house — as with the pot in the earlier mishnah, a handbreadth high and touching a handbreadth-wide opening: impurity above brings impurity to the house.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: A man lies on the threshold; the corpse is outside; the bearers tent over both. Bet Hillel radicalize their rule: the man is a tent joining the outside — where the corpse is — to the inside of the house. The mishnah's extremism lays bare the anxiety: no contact between the living and corpse-impurity can be tolerated, and the human body itself becomes the conduit.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT ISSUREI BIAH 1

Consequences before content: the penalty ladder

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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23 halachot

Halachah 1

הַבָּא עַל אַחַת מִכָּל הָעֲרָיוֹת הָאֲמוּרוֹת בַּתּוֹרָה בְּמֵזִיד חַיָּב כָּרֵת שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (ויקרא יח כט) "כִּי כָּל אֲשֶׁר יַעֲשֶׂה מִכֹּל הַתּוֹעֵבוֹת הָאֵלֶּה וְנִכְרְתוּ הַנְּפָשׁוֹת" וְגוֹ' שְׁנֵיהֶם הַבּוֹעֵל וְהַנִּבְעֶלֶת. וְאִם הָיוּ שׁוֹגְגִין חַיָּבִין חַטָּאת קְבוּעָה. וְיֵשׁ מִן הָעֲרָיוֹת שֶׁהוּא בְּמִיתַת בֵּית דִּין יֶתֶר עַל הַכָּרֵת הַשָּׁוֶה בְּכֻלָּן:

When a person voluntarily engages in sexual relations with one of the arayot mentioned in the Torah, he is liable for kerait, as [Leviticus 18:29] states: "Whenever anyone performs any of these abominations, the souls will be cut off...." [The plural is used, referring to] the man and the woman. If they transgressed unknowingly, they are liable to bring a fixed sin offering. There are some arayot with whom relations are punishable by execution in addition to kerait which is applicable in all cases.

Halachah 2

אוֹתָן הָעֲרָיוֹת שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהֶן מִיתַת בֵּית דִּין אִם הָיוּ שָׁם עֵדִים וְהַתְרָאָה וְלֹא פָּרְשׁוּ מִמַּעֲשֵׂיהֶם מְמִיתִין אוֹתָן מִיתָה הָאֲמוּרָה בָּהֶן:

With regard to the arayot that are punishable by execution by the court. If there were witnesses, they delivered a warning, and the transgressors did not cease their actions, they are executed through the means prescribed for them.

Halachah 3

וַאֲפִלּוּ הָיָה הָעוֹבֵר תַּלְמִיד חָכָם אֵין מְמִיתִין וְלֹא מַלְקִין עַד שֶׁתְּהֵיֶה שָׁם הַתְרָאָה. שֶׁלֹּא נִתְּנָה הַתְרָאָה בְּכָל מָקוֹם אֶלָּא לְהַבְחִין בֵּין שׁוֹגֵג לְמֵזִיד:

Even if a transgressor was a Torah scholar neither execution or lashes is administered unless a warning was given. For [the obligation for] a warning was instituted universally only to make a distinction between a person who transgresses inadvertently and one who transgresses intentionally.

Halachah 4

הָעֲרָיוֹת שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהֶן מִיתַת בֵּית דִּין מֵהֶן שֶׁמִּיתָתָן בִּסְקִילָה. וּמֵהֶן שֶׁמִּיתָתָן בִּשְׂרֵפָה. וּמֵהֶן שֶׁמִּיתָתָן בְּחֶנֶק. וְאֵלּוּ שֶׁמִּיתָתָן בִּסְקִילָה. הַבָּא עַל אִמּוֹ. וְעַל אֵשֶׁת אָבִיו. וְעַל אֵשֶׁת בְּנוֹ וְהִיא הַנִּקְרֵאת כַּלָּתוֹ. וְהַשּׁוֹכֵב עִם זָכָר. וְהַשּׁוֹכֵב עִם בְּהֵמָה. וְהָאִשָּׁה הַמְּבִיאָה אֶת הַבְּהֵמָה עָלֶיהָ:

Among the arayot punishable through execution by the court are those for [which the violators are] executed by stoning, those for which they are executed by burning, and those for which they are executed by strangulation. The following transgressions are punishable by stoning: one who has relations with his mother, with his father's wife, his son's wife; she is called his daughter-in-law, one who sodomizes a male, a male who has relations with an

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animal, and a woman who has relations with an animal.

Halachah 5

וְאֵלּוּ הֵן הָעֲרָיוֹת שֶׁמִּיתָתָן בִּשְׂרֵפָה. הַבָּא עַל בַּת אִשְׁתּוֹ בְּחַיֵּי אִשְׁתּוֹ. וְעַל בַּת בִּתָּהּ. וְעַל בַּת בְּנָהּ. וְעַל אֵם אִשְׁתּוֹ. וְעַל אֵם אִמָּהּ. וְעַל אֵם אָבִיהָ. וְהַבָּא עַל בִּתּוֹ. וְעַל בַּת בִּתּוֹ. וְעַל בַּת בְּנוֹ:

The following arayot are punishable by burning: a person who has relations with his wife's daughter during his wife's lifetime, with the daughter of her daughter, with the daughter of her son, with her mother, with the mother of her mother, with the mother of her father, with his own daughter, with the daughter of his daughter, or with the daughter of his son.

Halachah 6

אֵין לְךָ עֶרְוָה בְּחֶנֶק אֶלָּא אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ בִּלְבַד שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (ויקרא כ י) "מוֹת יוּמַת הַנֹּאֵף וְהַנֹּאָפֶת" וּמִיתָה הָאֲמוּרָה בַּתּוֹרָה סְתָם הִיא חֶנֶק. וְאִם הָיְתָה בַּת כֹּהֵן הִיא בִּשְׂרֵפָה וּבוֹעֲלָהּ בְּחֶנֶק שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (ויקרא כא ט) "וּבַת אִישׁ כֹּהֵן כִּי תֵחֵל לִזְנוֹת" (ויקרא כא ט) "בָּאֵשׁ תִּשָּׂרֵף". וְאִם הָיְתָה נַעֲרָה מְאֹרָשָׂה שְׁנֵיהֶם בְּסְקִילָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב כד) "כִּי תִהְיֶה נַעֲרָה בְתוּלָה" וְגוֹ' (דברים כב כד) "וּסְקַלְתֶּם אֹתָם בָּאֲבָנִים". וְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּתּוֹרָה (ויקרא כ יג) (ויקרא כ טז) "מוֹת יוּמְתוּ דְּמֵיהֶם בָּם" הֲרֵי הֵן בְּסְקִילָה:

The only instance in which forbidden sexual relations are punishable by execution by strangulation is adultery, as [derived from Leviticus 20:10]: "The adulterer and the adulteress shall surely be put to death." Whenever the Torah mentions "putting to death" without further description, the intent is strangulation. If [the adulteress] is the daughter of a priest, she should be executed by burning and the adulterer by strangulation, as [ibid. 21:9] states: "The daughter of a priest, when she begins to act promiscuously, she shall be burnt with fire." If the adulteress is a consecrated maiden, both she and the adulterer should be stoned, as [Deuteronomy 22:23-24] states: "When a virgin maiden.... they shall be stoned with rocks...." Whenever the Torah uses the phrase "They shall surely be put to death, they are responsible for their own blood" [Leviticus 20:11] - they are executed by stoning.

Halachah 7

שְׁאָר הָעֲרָיוֹת כֻּלָּן בִּכְרֵת בִּלְבַד וְאֵין בָּהֶם מִיתַת בֵּית דִּין. לְפִיכָךְ אִם הָיוּ שָׁם עֵדִים וְהַתְרָאָה בֵּית דִּין מַלְקִין אוֹתָן. שֶׁכָּל חַיָּבֵי כְּרֵתוֹת לוֹקִין:

All of the other arayot are punishable by kerait alone and are not punishable by execution by the court. Therefore if there were witnesses and a warning was administered, the court punishes them with lashes, for all those who are obligated for kerait are lashed.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Halachah 8

הַבָּא עַל אַחַת מֵחַיָּבֵי לָאוִין בְּמֵזִיד. הוּא לוֹקֶה וְהִיא. וְאִם בְּשׁוֹגֵג פְּטוּרִין מִכְּלוּם. וְהַבָּא עַל אַחַת מֵהַשְּׁנִיּוֹת בְּמֵזִיד מַכִּין אוֹתוֹ מַכַּת מַרְדּוּת מִדִּבְרֵיהֶם. אֲבָל הַבָּא עַל אַחַת מֵחַיָּבֵי עֲשֵׂה אֵינוֹ לוֹקֶה. וְאִם הִכּוּ אוֹתָם בֵּית דִּין מַכַּת מַרְדּוּת כְּדֵי לְהַרְחִיק מִן הָעֲבֵרָה הָרְשׁוּת בְּיָדָם:

When a person enters into relations with women who are forbidden by merely a negative commandment, both he and she are lashed. If they do so unknowingly, they are not liable for punishment. When a person enters into relations with one of the shniyot, Rabbinic Law ordains that he be given "stripes for rebellious conduct." When, however, a person enters into relations with a woman who is forbidden merely by a positive commandment, he need not be punished. If, however, the court [wishes to] administer stripes for rebellious conduct to him to distance him from sin, they have that option.

Halachah 9

אָנוּס פָּטוּר מִכְּלוּם מִן הַמַּלְקוֹת וּמִן הַקָּרְבָּן וְאֵין צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר מִן הַמִּיתָה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (דברים כב כו) "וְלַנַּעֲרָה לֹא תַעֲשֶׂה דָבָר". בַּמֶּה דְּבָרִים אֲמוּרִים בְּשֶׁנֶּאֱנַס הַנִּבְעָל. אֲבָל הַבּוֹעֵל אֵין לוֹ אֹנֶס שֶׁאֵין קְשׁוּי אֶלָּא לְדַעַת. וְאִשָּׁה שֶׁתְּחִלַּת בִּיאָתָהּ בְּאֹנֶס וְסוֹפָהּ בְּרָצוֹן פְּטוּרָה מִכְּלוּם שֶׁמִּשֶּׁהִתְחִיל לִבְעל בְּאֹנֶס אֵין בְּיָדָהּ שֶׁלֹּא תִּרְצֶה שֶׁיֵּצֵר הָאָדָם וְטִבְעוֹ כּוֹפֶה אוֹתָהּ לִרְצוֹת:

A person compelled [to engage in forbidden relations] is not liable at all, not for lashes nor for a sacrifice. Needless to say, there is no obligation for capital punishment, as [reflected by Deuteronomy 22:26]: "And to the maiden, do not do anything." To whom does the above apply? To the victim of rape. When, by contrast, a man engages in relations, there is no concept of being compelled against his will. For an erection is always a willful act. When a woman is compelled into relations at the outset and afterwards, she consents, she is not liable. Once [a man] compels her to engage in relations, it is beyond her control whether to desire [or] not. For man's natural tendency and inclination is compelling her to desire.

Halachah 10

הַמַּכְנִיס רֹאשׁ הָעֲטָרָה בִּלְבַד הוּא הַנִּקְרָא מְעָרֶה מִלְּשׁוֹן (ויקרא כ יח) "אֶת מְקֹרָהּ הֶעֱרָה". וְהַמַּכְנִיס כָּל הָאֵיבָר הוּא הַנִּקְרָא גּוֹמֵר. וּבְכָל הַבִּיאוֹת הָאֲסוּרוֹת אֶחָד הַמְּעָרֶה וְאֶחָד הַגּוֹמֵר וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁלֹּא הוֹצִיא שִׁכְבַת זֶרַע וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁפֵּרַשׁ וְלֹא גָּמַר כֵּיוָן שֶׁהִכְנִיס רֹאשׁ הָעֲטָרָה נִתְחַיְּבוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם מִיתַת בֵּית דִּין אוֹ כָּרֵת אוֹ מַלְקוֹת אוֹ מַכַּת מַרְדּוּת. (וְאֶחָד הַבָּא עַל הָעֶרְוָה כְּדַרְכָּהּ וְאֶחָד הַבָּא עָלֶיהָ שֶׁלֹּא כְּדַרְכָּהּ) מִשֶּׁיְּעָרֶה בָּהּ יִתְחַיְּבוּ שְׁנֵיהֶן מִיתָה אוֹ כָּרֵת אוֹ מַלְקוֹת אוֹ מַכַּת מַרְדּוּת בֵּין שֶׁהָיוּ שׁוֹכְבִין בֵּין שֶׁהָיוּ עוֹמְדִים עַל הַכְּנָסַת הָעֲטָרָה הוּא הַחִיּוּב:

A person who inserts the corona into [the woman's vaginal channel] is referred to as one who "uncovers" as [Leviticus 20:18] states: "He uncovered her source." A person who inserts the entire organ is referred to as one who completes [intercourse]. With regard to all the

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT LECH LECHA

The parting of Abram and Lot — and what of the sacred may be sold

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forbidden relations [mentioned] by the Torah, one who "uncovers" and one who "completes [intercourse] are [equally] liable for execution by the court, kerait, lashes, or stripes for rebellious conduct. Even though the man did not ejaculate and even if he withdrew and did not complete relations, [the man and the woman] both become liable. Whether a person engages in vaginal or anal intercourse, when he "uncovers" [the woman], they both become liable for execution, kerait, lashes, or stripes for rebellious conduct. Whether they were lying or standing, liability is established by the insertion of the corona.

Halachah 11

כָּל הַבָּא בְּיִאָה אֲסוּרָה בְּלֹא קִשּׁוּי. אֶלָּא שֶׁהָיָה הָאֵיבָר שֶׁלּוֹ מְדֻלְדָּל כְּמוֹ אֵיבָר הַמֵּתִים כְּגוֹן הַחוֹלִים. אוֹ מִי שֶׁנּוֹלַד כָּךְ כְּגוֹן סְרִיס חַמָּה אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהִכְנִיס אֶת הָאֵיבָר בְּיָדוֹ אֵינוֹ חַיָּב לֹא כָּרֵת וְלֹא מַלְקוּת וְאֵין צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר מִיתָה. שֵׁאֵין זוֹ בִּיאָה. אֲבָל פּוֹסֵל הוּא מִן הַתְּרוּמָה. וּבֵית דִּין מַכִּין אֶת שְׁנֵיהֶם מַכַּת מַרְדּוּת:

[There is never any liability when] a man engages in forbidden relations without an erection, instead his organ was hanging loosely like the organ of the dead, e.g., one who was sick or a person with a congenital malady, i.e., he was born sexually inadequate. Even though he inserts his organ with his hand, he is not liable for kerait or lashes. Needless to say, he is not liable for execution. For this is not considered sexual intercourse. Nevertheless, [such an act] disqualifies a woman from partaking of terumah. And the court subjects both of them to stripes for rebellious conduct.

Halachah 12

הַבָּא עַל עֶרְוָה מִן הָעֲרָיוֹת כְּמִתְעַסֵּק אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵין כַּוָּנָתוֹ לְכָךְ חַיָּב. וְכֵן בְּחַיָּבֵי לָאוִין וּבְשִׁנְיוֹת. אֲבָל הַבָּא עַל עֶרְוָה מִן הָעֲרָיוֹת וְהִיא מֵתָה פָּטוּר מִכְּלוּם. וְאֵין צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר בְּחַיָּבֵי לָאוִין שֶׁהוּא פָּטוּר. וְהַבָּא עַל הַטְּרֵפָה אוֹ שֶׁשָּׁכַב עִם בְּהֵמָה טְרֵפָה חַיָּב. חַי הוּא אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁסּוֹפוֹ לָמוּת מֵחֹלִי זֶה. וַאֲפִלּוּ שָׁחַט בָּהּ שְׁנֵי סִימָנִין וַעֲדַיִן הִיא מְפַרְכֶּסֶת הַבָּא עָלֶיהָ חַיָּב עַד שֶׁתָּמוּת אוֹ עַד שֶׁיַּתִּיז רֹאשָׁהּ:

When a person enters into sexual relations with one of the arayot as a casual act, although he did not intend to do so, he is liable.Similar concepts apply with regard to one who enters into relations with women forbidden by a negative commandment alone or with one of the shniyot. When, however, a man has relations with one of the arayot after she died, he is not liable at all. Needless to say, this applies with regard to those women with whom relations are forbidden by a negative commandment alone. When, by contrast, one has relations with a person who is trefe or who has relations with an animal which is trefe, he is liable. [The person or the animal] is [now] alive even though he will ultimately die from this illness. Even when the two signs which validate ritual slaughter were slit but [the woman or the animal] is making its last movements, if one enters into relations with [her or it] he is liable until she or it dies or is decapitated.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Halachah 13

כָּל אִשָּׁה אֲסוּרָה מֵאֵלּוּ אִם הָיְתָה בַּת שָׁלֹשׁ שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד וְמַעְלָה גָּדוֹל הַבָּא עָלֶיהָ חַיָּב מִיתָה אוֹ כָּרֵת אוֹ מַלְקוֹת וְהִיא פְּטוּרָה מִכְּלוּם אֶלָּא אִם כֵּן הָיְתָה גְּדוֹלָה. וְאִם הָיְתָה פְּחוּתָה מִזֶּה הֲרֵי שְׁנֵיהֶן פְּטוּרִין שֶׁאֵין בִּיאָתָהּ בִּיאָה. וְכֵן אִשָּׁה גְּדוֹלָה שֶׁבָּא עָלֶיהָ קָטָן אִם הָיָה בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד וְמַעְלָה הִיא חַיֶּבֶת כָּרֵת אוֹ מִיתָה אוֹ מַלְקוֹת וְהוּא פָּטוּר. וְאִם הָיָה בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וּלְמַטָּה שְׁנֵיהֶם פְּטוּרִין:

When an adult male enters into relations with any of the women forbidden in connection with the above transgressions who is three years and one day old or more, he is liable for execution, kerait, or lashes and she is not liable unless she is past majority. If she is younger than this, both participants are not liable, for the act is not considered as sexual relations. Similarly, when an adult woman enters into sexual relations with a minor, if he is nine years and one day old, she is liable for execution, kerait, or lashes and he is not liable. If he is younger than nine years old, they are both free of liability.

Halachah 14

הַבָּא עַל הַזָּכָר אוֹ הֵבִיא זָכָר עָלָיו כֵּיוָן שֶׁהֶעֱרָה אִם הָיוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם גְּדוֹלִים נִסְקָלִים שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (ויקרא יח כב) "וְאֶת זָכָר לֹא תִשְׁכָּב" בֵּין שֶׁהָיָה בּוֹעֵל אוֹ נִבְעָל. וְאִם הָיָה קָטָן בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד וָמַעְלָה זֶה שֶׁבָּא עָלָיו אוֹ הֵבִיאוֹ עַל עַצְמוֹ נִסְקָל וְהַקָּטָן פָּטוּר. וְאִם הָיָה הַזָּכָר בֶּן תֵּשַׁע אוֹ פָּחוֹת שְׁנֵיהֶן פְּטוּרִין וְרָאוּי לְבֵית דִּין לְהַכּוֹת הַגָּדוֹל מַכַּת מַרְדּוּת לְפִי שֶׁשָּׁכַב עִם זָכָר וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהוּא פָּחוֹת מִבֶּן תֵּשַׁע:

When a man enters into relations with a male or has a male enter into relations with him, once the corona is inserted [into the anus] they should both be stoned if they are both adults. As [Leviticus 18:22] states: "Do not lie with a man," [holding one liable for the act, whether] he is the active or passive partner. If a minor of nine years and a day or more is involved, the man who enters into relations or has the minor enter into relations with him should be stoned and the minor is not liable. If the male [minor] was less than nine years old, they are both free of liability. It is, however, appropriate for the court to subject the adult to stripes for rebellious conduct for homosexual relations although his companion was less than nine years old.

Halachah 15

[אֶחָד הַבָּא עַל הַזָּכָר אוֹ] הַבָּא עַל אַנְדְּרוֹגִינוּס דֶּרֶךְ זִכְרוּתוֹ חַיָּב. [וְאִם בָּא עָלָיו דֶּרֶךְ נְקֵבוּתוֹ פָּטוּר] וְהַטֻּמְטוּם סָפֵק הוּא לְפִיכָךְ הַבָּא עַל הַטֻּמְטוּם אוֹ עַל אַנְדְּרוֹגִינוּס [דֶּרֶךְ נְקֵבוּתוֹ] מַכִּין אוֹתוֹ מַכַּת מַרְדּוּת וְהָאַנְדְּרוֹגִינוּס מֻתָּר לִשָּׂא אִשָּׁה:

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One is liable for anal intercourse with an androgynus just as one is liable for relations with another male. One who engages in vaginal intercourse with [an androgynus] is not liable. There is a doubt concerning the gender of a tumtum. Therefore a person who has relations with a tumtum or vaginal intercourse with an androgynus should be given stripes for rebellious conduct. An androgynus may marry a woman.

Halachah 16

הַבָּא עַל הַבְּהֵמָה אוֹ שֶׁהֵבִיא בְּהֵמָה עָלָיו שְׁנֵיהֶן נִסְקָלִין שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (ויקרא יח כג) "וּבְכָל בְּהֵמָה לֹא תִתֵּן שְׁכָבְתְּךָ" בֵּין שֶׁרִבְּעָהּ אוֹ הֶבִיאָהּ עָלָיו. וְאֶחָד בְּהֵמָה וְאֶחָד חַיָּה וָעוֹף הַכֹּל בִּסְקִילָה. וְלֹא חִלֵּק הַכָּתוּב בִּבְהֵמָה בֵּין גְּדוֹלָה לִקְטַנָּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּבְכָל בְּהֵמָה אֲפִלּוּ בְּיוֹם לֵדָתָהּ (הַבָּא עָלֶיהָ בֵּין כְּדַרְכָּהּ בֵּין שֶׁלֹּא כְּדַרְכָּהּ) כֵּיוָן שֶׁהֶעֱרָה בָּהּ אוֹ שֶׁהֶעֱרְתָה בּוֹ חַיָּב:

When a person sodomizes an animal or has an animal insert its organ in him, both the person and the animal should be stoned to death, as [Leviticus 18:23] states: "Do not lie down with any animal," prohibiting [such relations] whether he sodomizes the animal or has the animal enter him. All [living creatures] animals, beasts, and fowl should be stoned to death. The Torah did not make any distinction with regard to the age of an animal whether it is young or old. "Any animal" implies a prohibition on the day of its birth. Whether the person enters into vaginal or anal intercourse with the animal, when he inserts the corona or the animal inserts the corona within him, they are liable.

Halachah 17

קָטָן בֶּן תֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁבָּא עַל הַבְּהֵמָה אוֹ הֶבִיאָהּ עָלָיו הִיא נִסְקֶלֶת עַל יָדוֹ וְהוּא פָּטוּר. הָיָה בֶּן תֵּשַׁע אוֹ פָּחוֹת אֵין סוֹקְלִין אֶת הַבְּהֵמָה. וְכֵן קְטַנָּה בַּת שָׁלֹשׁ שָׁנִים וְיוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁהֵבִיאָה בְּהֵמָה וְחַיָּה עָלֶיהָ בֵּין בְּהֵמָה גְּדוֹלָה בֵּין בְּהֵמָה קְטַנָּה כֵּיוָן שֶׁהֶעֱרְתָה בָּהּ הַבְּהֵמָה (בֵּין כְּדַרְכָּהּ בֵּין שֶׁלֹּא כְּדַרְכָּהּ) הַבְּהֵמָה נִסְקֶלֶת וְהִיא פְּטוּרָה. וְאִם הָיְתָה גְּדוֹלָה שְׁנֵיהֶן נִסְקָלִין. וְאִם הָיְתָה מִבַּת שָׁלֹשׁ שָׁנִים וּלְמַטָּה אֵין הַבְּהֵמָה נִסְקֶלֶת:

When a boy nine years old sodomizes an animal or has an animal engage in relations with him, the animal should be stoned, but he is not liable. If the boy was less than nine years old, the animal is not stoned. Similarly, when a girl three years old or more causes an animal or a beast to have relations with her, whether it is an older animal or a younger animal, once the corona of the animal is inserted into her vagina or anus, the animal is stoned to death and she is not liable. If she was past majority, they both should be stoned to death. If she was less than three years old, the animal should not be stoned.

Halachah 18

וְכֵן הַשּׁוֹכֵב עִם הַבְּהֵמָה בִּשְׁגָגָה וְהַאִשָּׁה שֶׁהֵבִיאָה אֶת הַבְּהֵמָה עָלֶיהָ בִּשְׁגָגָה אֵין הַבְּהֵמָה נִסְקֶלֶת עַל

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT LECH LECHA

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יָדָן וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהֵן גְּדוֹלִים. כָּל הָעֲרָיוֹת כֻּלָּן שֶׁהָיָה אֶחָד גָּדוֹל וְאֶחָד קָטָן הַקָּטָן פָּטוּר וְהַגָּדוֹל חַיָּב כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ. אֶחָד עֵר וְאֶחָד יָשֵׁן הַיָּשֵׁן פָּטוּר. אֶחָד מֵזִיד וְאֶחָד שׁוֹגֵג הַמֵּזִיד חַיָּב וְהַשּׁוֹגֵג מֵבִיא קָרְבָּן. אֶחָד אָנוּס וְאֶחָד בְּרָצוֹן הָאָנוּס פָּטוּר כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ:

When a person lies with an animal inadvertently or a woman causes an animal to have relations with her inadvertently, the animal is not stoned to death even though they are past majority. With regard to [relations with] all the arayot, when one is an adult and the other a minor, the minor is not liable and the adult is liable, as explained. If one is awake and one is sleeping, the one who is sleeping is not liable. If one [transgresses] intentionally and the other inadvertently, the one who [transgresses] intentionally is liable and the one who transgresses inadvertently must bring a sacrifice. If one acted under duress and one acted willingly, the one who acted under duress is not liable as stated above.

Halachah 19

אֵין הָעֵדִים נִזְקָקִין לִרְאוֹת הַמְנָאֲפִים שֶׁהֶעֱרוּ זֶה בָּזֶה וְהִכְנִיס כְּמִכְחוֹל בִּשְׁפוֹפֶרֶת. אֶלָּא מִשֶּׁיִּרְאוּ אוֹתָן דְּבוּקִין זֶה עִם זֶה כְּדֶרֶךְ כָּל הַבּוֹעֲלִין הֲרֵי אֵלּוּ נֶהֱרָגִין בִּרְאִיָּה זוֹ. וְאֵין אוֹמְרִים שֶׁמָּא לֹא הֶעֱרָה, מִפְּנֵי שֶׁחֶזְקַת צוּרָה זוֹ שֶׁהֶעֱרָה:

The witnesses are not required to see [the precise details] of couple's intimate relations, the man inserting [his organ]as one inserts a piston into a pipe. Instead, once they see them clinging together as is the way of all who engage in relations, they may be executed on the basis of this evidence. We do not say: Maybe he did not insert the corona, because we can assume that in this position, the corona was inserted.

Halachah 20

מִי שֶׁהֶחְזַק בְּשֹׁאַר בָּשָׂר דָּנִין בּוֹ עַל פִּי הַחֲזָקָה. אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵין שָׁם רְאָיָה בְּרוּרָה שֶׁזֶּה קָרוֹב. וּמַלְקִין וְשׁוֹרְפִין וְסוֹקְלִין וְחוֹנְקִין עַל חֲזָקָה זוֹ. כֵּיצַד. הֲרֵי שֶׁהֶחְזַק שֶׁזּוֹ אֲחוֹתוֹ אוֹ בִּתּוֹ אוֹ אִמּוֹ וּבָא עָלֶיהָ בְּעֵדִים הֲרֵי זֶה לוֹקֶה אוֹ נִשְׂרָף אוֹ נִסְקָל וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵין שָׁם רְאָיָה בְּרוּרָה שֶׁזּוֹ הִיא אֲחוֹתוֹ אוֹ אִמּוֹ אוֹ בִּתּוֹ אֶלָּא בַּחֲזָקָה בִּלְבַד. וּמַעֲשֶׂה בְּאִשָּׁה אַחַת שֶׁבָּאת לִירוּשָׁלַיִם וְתִינוֹק מֻרְכָּב לָהּ עַל כְּתֵפָהּ וְהִגְדִּילַתּוּ בְּחֶזְקַת שֶׁהוּא בְּנָהּ וּבָא עָלֶיהָ וֶהֱבִיאוּהָ לְבֵית דִּין וּסְקָלוּהָ. רְאָיָה לְדִין זֶה מַה שֶּׁדָּנָה תּוֹרָה בְּמְקַלֵּל אָבִיו וּמַכֶּה אָבִיו שֶׁיּוּמַת. וּמִנַּיִן לָנוּ רְאָיָה בְּרוּרָה שֶׁזֶּה אָבִיו, אֶלָּא בַּחֲזָקָה, כָּךְ שְׁאָר קְרוֹבִים בַּחֲזָקָה:

When an established presumption that people are close relatives has been established, we judge accordingly even though there is no clear proof that they were relatives. We give lashes and execute by burning, stoning, and strangulation based on such a presumption. What is implied? If it is an accepted presumption that a particular woman is a man's sister, daughter, or mother and he had relations with her in the presence of witnesses, he is given lashes or executed by burning or stoning even though there is no clear-cut evidence that the

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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woman is his sister, mother, or daughter, only the accepted presumption. An incident occurred with a woman who came to Jerusalem carrying an infant on her shoulders and she raised it, [establishing] the assumption that he was her son. [After he grew older,] he had relations with her and they brought her to the court who executed her by stoning. A proof of this law can be drawn from the fact that the Torah speaks of the judgment of execution for one who curses his father and strikes his father How can we find clear proof that he is his father? Instead, we operate according to the existing presumption. So, too, with regard to other relatives, we operate according to the existing presumption.

Halachah 21

אִישׁ וְאִשָּׁה שֶׁבָּאוּ מִמְּדִינַת הַיָּם הוּא אוֹמֵר זֹאת אִשְׁתִּי וְהִיא אוֹמֶרֶת זֶה בַּעֲלִי. אִם הֶחֱזָקָה בָּעִיר שְׁלֹשִׁים יוֹם שֶׁהִיא אִשְׁתּוֹ הוֹרְגִין עָלֶיהָ. אֲבָל בְּתוֹךְ הַשְּׁלֹשִׁים יוֹם אֵין הוֹרְגִין עָלֶיהָ מִשּׁוּם אֵשֶׁת אִישׁ:

[The following rules apply when] a man and a woman come from overseas, he says: "This is my wife," and she says: "This is my husband." If in [their new] city, he establishes the presumption that she is his wife for 30 days, we execute [an adulterer who has relations] with her. Within 30 days, however, we do not execute anyone on the presumption that she is a married woman.

Halachah 22

הָאִשָּׁה שֶׁהֶחֱזְקָה נִדָּה בִּשְׁכוּנוֹתֶיהָ בַּעְלָהּ לוֹקֶה עָלֶיהָ מִשּׁוּם נִדָּה. הַמְקַנֵּא לְאִשְׁתּוֹ וְנִסְתְּרָה וּבָא עֵד אֶחָד וְהֵעִיד שֶׁנִּטְמְאָה וְהָיָה בַּעְלָהּ כֹּהֵן וּבָא עָלֶיהָ אַחַר כָּךְ הֲרֵי זֶה לוֹקֶה עָלֶיהָ מִשּׁוּם זוֹנָה. אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁעִקַּר הָעֵדוּת בְּעֵד אֶחָד כְּבָר הֶחֱזְקָה בְּזוֹנָה:

When a woman is presumed to be a niddah among her neighbors, her husband is given lashes for [engaging in relations] with her in the niddah state. [The following rule applies when] a person issues a warning [not to enter into seclusion with a specific man] to his wife and she enters into seclusion with him. If one witness comes and testifies that she was unfaithful, her husband was a priest, and he engaged in relations with her afterwards, he receives lashes because of her because he had relations with a zonah. Although the fundamental element of this testimony is established by one witness, [her conduct caused] her identity to be established as a zonah.

Halachah 23

הָאָב שֶׁאָמַר בִּתִּי זוֹ מְקֻדֶּשֶׁת הִיא לָזֶה אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהוּא נֶאֱמָן וְתִנָּשֵׂא לוֹ אִם זְנָתָה אֵינָהּ נִסְקֶלֶת עַל פִּיו עַד שֶׁיִּהְיוּ שָׁם עֵדִים שֶׁנִּתְאָרְסָה בִּפְנֵיהֶם. וְכֵן הָאִשָּׁה שֶׁאָמְרָה מְקֻדֶּשֶׁת אֲנִי אֵינָהּ נֶהֱרֶגֶת עַל פִּיהָ עַד שֶׁיִּהְיוּ שָׁם עֵדִים אוֹ תֶּחְזַק:

When a father says: "My daughter is consecrated to this person," his word is accepted and she must marry him. [Nevertheless,] if she acts unfaithfully while [consecrated] to him, she

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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is not stoned to death because of her father's statements unless there are witnesses [who testify] that she was consecrated in their presence. Similarly, when a woman states: "I have been consecrated," [if it is discovered that she engaged in relations with another man,] she is not executed on the basis of her own statements. Instead, there must be witnesses [that she was consecrated] or she must have established a common conception [that this was the case].

Commentary

The Rambam opens the entire book of forbidden relations not with a single prohibition but with a taxonomy of consequences — a descending ladder from the cosmic to the procedural. Halachot 1-3 set the tiers: karet for deliberate violation, court execution only with witnesses and formal warning (hatraah), and the striking rule that even a Torah scholar gets no exemption from warning, because warning exists universally 'to distinguish between the inadvertent and the deliberate.' Knowledge, however vast, does not substitute for procedure.

Halachot 4-6 then sort the executions into their three modes with exhaustive lists — stoning, burning, and strangulation, the last reserved for adultery alone — plus the elegant default rule that an unspecified 'מות יומת' always means strangulation. From there the chapter descends to the act's boundaries (compulsion exempts; the casual-but-unintended act still binds; age thresholds) and finally to evidence: witnesses need not see everything, presumption (chazakah) judges, the overseas couple is believed. Theology first, courtroom last.

The commentators show their classic methods. Maggid Mishneh is the source-tracer: on 1:1 he simply names the Talmudic addresses — 'בתחלת המסכתא ...כבר נתבאר פ"א מהלכות אישות ומהם בכריתות' — anchoring the Rambam's opening in Keritot. Tzafnat Pa'neach is the conceptual analyst: on the warning requirement he digs into why — 'דהנאה אית להו לתרווייהו הטעם משום,' both parties derive pleasure — weaving Bava Kamma 32a, Tosafot Yoma 82b and Rashi Keritot 3a into a theory of the warning's rationale. Steinsaltz glosses the terms for the modern reader: karet as death at heaven's hand, the fixed chatat against the sliding ויורד עולה.

The gem is halachah 3's quiet radicalism: the scholar stands in the dock exactly like the ignoramus. In a book about graded sanctity, the Rambam grades the penalty but not the person — procedure is the great leveler, and the line between shogeg and mezid is drawn by a formal act, never by assumed intent.

Maggid Mishneh on Issurei Biah 1:1:1; Tzafnat Pa'neach on 1:1:1-2; Steinsaltz on 1:1:1-4 — all via Sefaria.

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The state on this week's learning

Two government documents meet the week's learning head-on: the Chief Rabbinate's living administration of firstborn-animal law — the daf's own subject — and the Aliyah Ministry's anchoring of its flagship day in this week's parsha.

טופס הרשאה למכירת קנה וושט של בקר וצאן שטרם המליטו

הרבנות הראשית לישראל

The Chief Rabbinate's authorization form for selling the trachea and esophagus of not-yet-calved cattle and sheep — the modern centralized mechanism (via the Rabbinate's Bechorot desk) that keeps dairy herds out of the firstborn-animal sanctity problem. The form states the premise outright: a firstborn 'יש בו קדושה... אותו לכהן ואין לסחור בו או לשחוט אותו לכן יש לתת' — you may not trade in it. Today's daf (Bekhorot 32) is the Talmudic source of exactly that rule: when, and by whom, a consecrated animal may be sold.

https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/service/permit-to-sell-the-firstborns-of-cattle-or-sheep/he/AuthorizationForm.pdf

מבחני תמיכה לקליטת עלייה ברשויות המקומיות 2024

משרד העלייה והקליטה

The Ministry of Aliyah and Integration's funding criteria instruct local authorities to run Yom HaAliyah programming on 7 Cheshvan — explicitly '(לך-פרשת לך)' — the week of this parsha, per the government decision establishing the day. The state's immigration-absorption calendar is anchored in Abraham's original aliyah: 'לך לך מארצך.'

https://www.gov.il/BlobFolder/rfp/local_authorities_aliah_procedure_2024/he/cahpter6-2024.pdf

NLI ·

From the National Library

The National Library's catalog holds 'והשב את העבודה: הבהמה ומעשר בהמה השנויים במסכת בכורות תמצית הלכות מומי' — a modern Hebrew digest of the laws of animal blemishes and the animal tithe as taught in tractate Bekhorot, 'בליווי תמונות,' with illustrations. It is the daf's own curriculum, compressed for study: the two halves of today's page — which blemishes disqualify, and what may be sold of the tithe — bound into one study volume. (No digitized image of this item was verifiable through the catalog relay, so it is cited here in prose.)

תמצית הלכות מומי הבהמה ומעשר בהמה השנויים במסכת בכורות : והשב את העבודה

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 3

Genesis 13:5-13:18

14 verses

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Shnayim mikra: each verse of the day's aliyah twice in Hebrew, once in Targum Onkelos — the ancient Aramaic ear on the text. Today: the parting of Abram and Lot, the herdsmen's quarrel, Lot's choice of the Jordan plain, and the renewed promise of the land.

אברם

Genesis 13:5 · ×2

וְגַם־לְלוֹט הַהֹלֵךְ אֶת־אַבְרָם הָיָה צֹאן־וּבָקָר וְאֹהָלִים:
וְגַם־לְלוֹט הַהֹלֵךְ אֶת־אַבְרָם הָיָה צֹאן־וּבָקָר וְאֹהָלִים:
וְאַף לְלוֹט דְּאָזֵיל עִם אַבְרָם הֲוָה עָאן וְתוֹרִין וּמַשְׁכְּנִין:

הארץ

Genesis 13:6 · ×2

וְלֹא־נָשָׂא אֹתָם הָאָרֶץ לָשֶׁבֶת יַחְדָּו כִּי־הָיָה רְכוּשָׁם רָב וְלֹא יָכְלוּ לָשֶׁבֶת יַחְדָּו:
וְלֹא־נָשָׂא אֹתָם הָאָרֶץ לָשֶׁבֶת יַחְדָּו כִּי־הָיָה רְכוּשָׁם רָב וְלֹא יָכְלוּ לָשֶׁבֶת יַחְדָּו:
וְלָא סוֹבְרַת יְתְהוֹן אַרְעָא לְמִיתַב כַּחֲדָא אֲרֵי הֲוָה קִנְיָנְהוֹן סַגִּי וְלָא יְכִילוּ לְמִיתַב כַּחֲדָא:

ובין

Genesis 13:7 · ×2

וַיְהִי־רִיב בֵּין רֹעֵי מִקְנֵה־אַבְרָם וּבֵין רֹעֵי מִקְנֵה־לוֹט וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי וְהַפְּרִזִּי אָז יֹשֵׁב בָּאָרֶץ:
וַיְהִי־רִיב בֵּין רֹעֵי מִקְנֵה־אַבְרָם וּבֵין רֹעֵי מִקְנֵה־לוֹט וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי וְהַפְּרִזִּי אָז יֹשֵׁב בָּאָרֶץ:
וַהֲוָת מַצּוּתָא בֵּין רָעֵי בְעִירֵיהּ דְּאַבְרָם וּבֵין רָעֵי בְעִירֵיהּ דְּלוֹט וּכְנַעֲנָאָה וּפְרִזָאָה בְּכֵן יָתִיב בְּאַרְעָא:

Genesis 13:8 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָם אֶל־לוֹט אַל־נָא תְהִי מְרִיבָה בֵּינִי וּבֵינֶךָ וּבֵין רֹעַי וּבֵין רֹעֶיךָ כִּי־אֲנָשִׁים אַחִים אֲנָחְנוּ:
וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָם אֶל־לוֹט אַל־נָא תְהִי מְרִיבָה בֵּינִי וּבֵינֶךָ וּבֵין רֹעַי וּבֵין רֹעֶיךָ כִּי־אֲנָשִׁים אַחִים אֲנָחְנוּ:
וַאֲמַר אַבְרָם לְלוֹט לָא כְעַן תְּהֵי מַצּוּתָא בֵּינָא וּבֵינָךְ וּבֵין רַעֲוָתַי וּבֵין רַעֲוָתָךְ אֲרֵי גּוּבְרִין אַחִין אֲנָחְנָא:

לצפונא

Genesis 13:9 · ×2

הֲלֹא כָל־הָאָרֶץ לְפָנֶיךָ הִפָּרֶד נָא מֵעָלָי אִם־הַשְּׂמֹאל וְאֵימְנָה וְאִם־הַיָּמִין וְאַשְׂמְאִילָה:
הֲלֹא כָל־הָאָרֶץ לְפָנֶיךָ הִפָּרֶד נָא מֵעָלָי אִם־הַשְּׂמֹאל וְאֵימְנָה וְאִם־הַיָּמִין וְאַשְׂמְאִילָה:
הֲלָא כָל אַרְעָא קֳדָמָךְ אִתְפְּרַשׁ כְּעַן מִלְוָתִי אִם אַתְּ לְצִפּוּנָא וַאֲנָא לְדָרוֹמָא וְאִם אַתְּ לְדָרוֹמָא וַאֲנָא לְצִפּוּנָא:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Genesis 13:10 · ×2

וַיִּשָּׂא־לוֹט אֶת־עֵינָיו וַיַּרְא֣ אֶת־כָּל־כִּכַּר הַיַּרְדֵּן כִּי כֻלָּהּ מַשְׁקֶה לִפְנֵי ׀ שַׁחֵת יְהוָה֮ אֶת־סְדֹם֒ וְאֶת־עֲמֹרָה֙ כְּגַן־יְהוָ֔ה כְּאֶ֖רֶץ מִצְרַ֑יִם בֹּאֲכָ֖ה צֹֽעַר׃

וַיִּשָּׂא־לוֹט אֶת־עֵינָיו וַיַּרְא֣ אֶת־כָּל־כִּכַּר הַיַּרְדֵּן כִּי כֻלָּהּ מַשְׁקֶה לִפְנֵי ׀ שַׁחֵת יְהוָה֮ אֶת־סְדֹם֒ וְאֶת־עֲמֹרָה֙ כְּגַן־יְהוָ֔ה כְּאֶ֖רֶץ מִצְרַ֑יִם בֹּאֲכָ֖ה צֹֽעַר׃

וּזְקַף לוֹט יָת עֵינוֹהִי וַחֲזָא יָת כָּל מֵישַׁר יַרְדְּנָא אֲרֵי כֻלַּהּ בֵּית שַׁקְיָא קֳדָם חַבָּלוּת יְיָ יָת סְדוֹם וְיָת עֲמוֹרָה כְּגִינְתָא דַיְיָ כְּאַרְעָא דְמִצְרַיִם מָטֵי לְצֹעַר׃

Genesis 13:11 · ×2

וַיִּבְחַר־לוֹ֣ לוֹט֮ אֵת֣ כָּל־כִּכַּר֒ הַיַּרְדֵּ֣ן וַיִּסַּ֣ע לוֹט֮ מִקֶּדֶם֒ וַיִּפָּרְד֣וּ אִ֔ישׁ מֵעַ֖ל אָחִֽיו׃

וַיִּבְחַר־לוֹ֣ לוֹט֮ אֵת֣ כָּל־כִּכַּר֒ הַיַּרְדֵּ֣ן וַיִּסַּ֣ע לוֹט֮ מִקֶּדֶם֒ וַיִּפָּרְד֣וּ אִ֔ישׁ מֵעַ֖ל אָחִֽיו׃

וּבְחַר לֵיהּ לוֹט יָת כָּל מֵישַׁר יַרְדְּנָא וּנְטַל לוֹט מִלְּקַדְמִין וְאִתְפְּרָשׁוּ גְּבַר מִלְוָת אֲחוּהִי׃

Genesis 13:12 · ×2

אַבְרָ֖ם יָשַׁ֣ב בְּאֶֽרֶץ־כְּנָ֑עַן וְלוֹט֙ יָשַׁ֣ב׀ בְּעָרֵ֣י הַכִּכָּ֔ר וַיֶּ֥אֱהַל עַד־סְדֹֽם׃

אַבְרָ֖ם יָשַׁ֣ב בְּאֶֽרֶץ־כְּנָ֑עַן וְלוֹט֙ יָשַׁ֣ב׀ בְּעָרֵ֣י הַכִּכָּ֔ר וַיֶּ֥אֱהַל עַד־סְדֹֽם׃

אַבְרָם יָתֵב בְּאַרְעָא דְכְנָעַן וְלוֹט יָתֵב בְּקִירְוֵי מֵישְׁרָא וּפְרַס עַד סְדוֹם׃

Genesis 13:13 · ×2

וְאַנְשֵׁ֥י סְדֹ֛ם רָעִ֖ים וְחַטָּאִ֑ים לַיהוָ֖ה מְאֹֽד׃

וְאַנְשֵׁ֥י סְדֹ֛ם רָעִ֖ים וְחַטָּאִ֑ים לַיהוָ֖ה מְאֹֽד׃

וֶאֱנָשִׁין (ס"א וַאֲנָשֵׁי) דְּסְדוֹם בִּישִׁין בְּמָמוֹנְהוֹן וְחַיְבִין בִּגְוַיְתְהוֹן קֳדָם יְיָ לַחֲדָא׃

Genesis 13:14 · ×2

וַיהוָ֞ה אָמַ֣ר אֶל־אַבְרָ֗ם אַחֲרֵי֙ הִפָּרֶד־לוֹט֙ מֵעִמּ֔וֹ שָׂ֣א נָ֔א עֵינֶ֖יךָ וּרְאֵ֑ה מִן־הַמָּקוֹם֙ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּ֣ה שָׁ֔ם צָפֹ֥נָה וָנֶ֖גְבָּה וָקֵ֥דְמָה וָיָֽמָּה׃

וַיהוָ֞ה אָמַ֣ר אֶל־אַבְרָ֗ם אַחֲרֵי֙ הִפָּרֶד־לוֹט֙ מֵעִמּ֔וֹ שָׂ֣א נָ֔א עֵינֶ֖יךָ וּרְאֵ֑ה מִן־הַמָּקוֹם֙ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּ֣ה שָׁ֔ם צָפֹ֥נָה וָנֶ֖גְבָּה וָקֵ֥דְמָה וָיָֽמָּה׃

וַיְיָ אֲמַר לְאַבְרָם בָּתַר דְּאִתְפְּרַשׁ לוֹט מֵעִמֵּיהּ זְקוֹף כְּעַן עֵינָךְ וַחֲזֵי מִן אַתְרָא דְאַתְּ תַּמָּן לְצַפּוּנָא וּלְדָרוֹמָא וּלְמַדִּינְחָא וּלְמַעֲרָבָא׃

Genesis 13:15 · ×2

כִּ֣י אֶת־כָּל־הָאָ֗רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּ֣ה רֹאֶ֔ה לְךָ֥ אֶתְּנֶ֖נָּה וּלְזַרְעֲךָ֑ עַד־עוֹלָֽם׃

כִּ֣י אֶת־כָּל־הָאָ֗רֶץ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּ֣ה רֹאֶ֔ה לְךָ֥ אֶתְּנֶ֖נָּה וּלְזַרְעֲךָ֑ עַד־עוֹלָֽם׃

אֲרֵי יָת כָּל אַרְעָא דִּי אַתְּ חָזֵי לָךְ אֶתְּנִנַּהּ וּלְבָנָךְ עַד עָלַם׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Genesis 13:16 · ×2

וְשַׂמְתִּי אֶת־זַרְעֲךָ כַּעֲפַר הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר | אִם־יוּכַל אִישׁ לִמְנוֹת אֶת־עֲפַר הָאָרֶץ גַּם־זַרְעֲךָ יִמָּנֶה׃
וְשַׂמְתִּי אֶת־זַרְעֲךָ כַּעֲפַר הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר | אִם־יוּכַל אִישׁ לִמְנוֹת אֶת־עֲפַר הָאָרֶץ גַּם־זַרְעֲךָ יִמָּנֶה׃
וַאֲשַׁוֵּי יָת בְּנָךְ סַגִּיאִין כְּעַפְרָא דְאַרְעָא כְּמָא דִּי לָא אֶפְשַׁר לְגָבַר לְמִמְנֵי יָת עַפְרָא דְאַרְעָא אַף בְּנָךְ לָא יִתְמְנוּן׃

Genesis 13:17 · ×2

קוּם הִתְהַלֵּךְ בָּאָרֶץ לְאָרְכָּהּ וּלְרָחְבָּהּ כִּי לְךָ אֶתְּנֶנָּה׃
קוּם הִתְהַלֵּךְ בָּאָרֶץ לְאָרְכָּהּ וּלְרָחְבָּהּ כִּי לְךָ אֶתְּנֶנָּה׃
קוּם הַלִּיךְ בְּאַרְעָא לְאָרְכַּהּ וּלְפָתְיַהּ אֲרֵי לָךְ אֶתְּנִנַּהּ׃

Genesis 13:18 · ×2

וַיֶּאֱהַל אַבְרָם וַיָּבֹא וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּאֵלֹנֵי מַמְרֵא אֲשֶׁר בְּחֶבְרוֹן וַיִּבֶן־שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ לַיהוָה׃
וַיֶּאֱהַל אַבְרָם וַיָּבֹא וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּאֵלֹנֵי מַמְרֵא אֲשֶׁר בְּחֶבְרוֹן וַיִּבֶן־שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ לַיהוָה׃
וּפְרַס אַבְרָם וַאֲתָא וִיתֵב בְּמֵישְׁרֵי מַמְרֵא דִּי בְחֶבְרוֹן וּבְנָא תַּמָּן מַדְבְּחָא קֳדָם יְיָ׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 13:7

A historian's aside: 'והכנעני והפרזי' — the Perizzites, Shadal suggests, arrived in the land while Abraham was down in Egypt. The verse's throwaway 'who were then dwelling in the land' becomes a chronological marker.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 13:9

Pure grammar in two words: 'מגזרת ימין. ואימינה' — 'and I will go right' is from the root ימין. Ibn Ezra the grammarian refuses to let a rare form pass without its derivation.

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 13:9

An elaborate defense of the verse's syntax: 'לפניך' does not mean 'before you' (facing) but the inclination of thought and will toward a choice (Richtung/Wendung) — so no words need emending and the translators' additions are unnecessary.

Shadal · Gen 13:10

Philology: ככר (plain) is a doubled form of כר — 'כמו בבל, משפטו כרכר' — like Babylon from Babel. The Jordan 'plain' carries its doubling in its name.

Cassuto · Gen 13:5-18

Cassuto's keyword method at full power: the promise paragraph (vv.14-17) repeats the word ארץ seven times — 'אין לראות דבר שבמקרה' — no accident, the chapter's Leitwort. And Lot's departure is itself a nisayon, a trial: Abraham, still childless, surrenders his

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heir-apparent for the sake of peace.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 13:9

אם את לצפונא ואנא לדרומא אסהשמאל ואימנה

Where the Hebrew leaves 'left' and 'right' ambiguous, Onkelos disambiguates decisively into compass points: north and south. No reader is left wondering which way anyone faces — the translator as surveyor.

Gen 13:13

בישין בממונהון וחיבין בגויתהון קדם יי לחדא רעים וחטאים ליהוה מאד

Onkelos's most famous move in the aliyah: he splits 'wicked and sinful' into two domains — evil in their money, guilty in their bodies — importing the Sanhedrin 109a reading directly into the translation. The Aramaic reader meets the midrash before ever opening the Talmud.

Gen 13:14

לצפונא ולדרומא ולמדינחא ולמערבא צפנה ונגבה וקדמה וימה

The four directional -ah suffixes become four fixed Aramaic compass nouns. Where Hebrew gestures with an adverbial ending, Onkelos names the directions as places — north, south, east, west as territories on a map.

Gen 13:6

ולא סוברת יתהון ארעא ולאנשא אתם הארץ

The land 'could not bear them' — Onkelos keeps the anthropomorphism (סבר, to bear/endure) rather than flattening it. The earth itself is a character with a carrying capacity.

Gen 13:15-16

ית בנך סגיאין כעפרא דארעא ... ולבנך אתזרעך כעפר הארץ ... ולזרעך

Onkelos's signature theological edit: 'seed' (זרע) becomes 'your sons' (בנך) — and in v.16, 'your many sons.' The abstract agricultural metaphor is made human and numerous; the promise is about people, not produce.

Gen 13:18

ובנא תמן מדבחא קדם יי ויבושם מזבח ליהוה

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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The קדם periphrasis for divine contact: the altar is built 'before the Lord,' not 'to the Lord' — Onkelos's standing guard against any hint of divine need or locality.

Gen 13:12

ופרס עד סדום ויאהל עדסדם

'He tented as far as Sodom' — Onkelos reads ויאהל as pitching/spreading (פרס) rather than dwelling. The verb keeps its motion: Lot's tents creep toward Sodom, staging his drift before the verse states it.

Gen 13:7

והות מצותא בין רעי בעיריה דאברם ויהיריב בין רעי מקנהאברם

'Strife' becomes מצותא (contention, legal dispute) and 'Abram's livestock' becomes 'his cattle' (בעיריה) — Onkelos narrows מקנה (movable property) to actual animals, the economic reality behind the quarrel.

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

21 comments

All 21 of Rashi's comments on Genesis 13:5-18, printed in full — from Lot's borrowed prosperity (ההלך את אברם — what brought him all this? His walking with Abram') to the men of Sodom, dissected word by word, to Abram's settling at Mamre's terebinths.

ההלך את אברם.

מִי גָּרַם שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ זֹאת? הֲלִיכָתוֹ עִם אַבְרָם:

ההלך את אברם *WHO WENT WITH ABRAM — What brought it about that he possessed all this?*

The fact that he was accompanying Abram (Genesis Rabbah 41:3;

Pesikta Rabbati, שמיני).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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PARSHAT LECH LECHA

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Tuesday, 20 October 2026 · Aliyah 3/7 (Genesis 13:5-13:18) · Daf Bekhorot 32

ולא נשא אתם.

לֹא הָיְתָה יְכוֹלָה לְהַסְפִּיק מִרְעֶה לְמִקְנֵיהֶם, וְלָשׁוֹן קָצָר הוּא, וְצָרִיךְ לְהוֹסִיף עָלָיו, כְּמוֹ וְלֹא נָשָׂא אוֹתָם מִרְעֵה הָאָרֶץ,

ולא נשא אתם *AND THE LAND WAS NOT ABLE TO BEAR THEM — It could not provide sufficient pasture for their cattle.*

The phrase is elliptical and a word must be supplied, for instance:

לְפִיכָךְ כָּתַב וְלֹא נָשָׂא בִלְשׁוֹן זָכָר:

the pasturage (מרעה) of the land was not able to bear them — for this reason the word נשא (masculine) is used (to agree in gender with מרעה;

the suggestion is that נשא cannot have הארץ as subject since that noun is feminine).

ויהי ריב.

לְפִי שֶׁהָיוּ רוֹעִים שֶׁל לוֹט רְשָׁעִים וּמַרְעִים בְּהֶמְתָּם בִּשְׂדוֹת אֲחֵרִים,

ויהי ריב *AND THERE WAS A QUARREL because Lot's shepherds were wicked men and grazed their cattle in other people's fields.*

וְרוֹעֵי אַבְרָם מוֹכִיחִים אוֹתָם עַל הַגֶּזֶל, וְהֵם אוֹמְרִים נִתְּנָה הָאָרֶץ לְאַבְרָם, וְלוֹ אֵין יוֹרֵשׁ, וְלוֹט יוֹרְשׁוֹ, וְאֵין זֶה גֶּזֶל,

Abram's shepherds rebuked them for this act of robbery, but they replied, "The land has been given to Abram, and since he has no son as heir, Lot will be his heir:

וְהַכָּתוּב אוֹמֵר וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי וְהַפְּרִזִּי אָז יֹשֵׁב בָּאָרֶץ, וְלֹא זָכָה בָהּ אַבְרָם עֲדַיִן (ב"):

consequently this is not robbery".

Scripture, however, states: "The Canaanite and the Perizzite abode then in the land", so that Abram was not yet entitled to possession (Genesis Rabbah 41:5).

אנשים אחים.

קְרוֹבִים, וּמִדְרַשׁ אַגָּדָה דּוֹמִין בְּקִלַּסְתֵּר פָּנִים:

אנשים אחים *BROTHERS — i. e. kinsmen.*

The Midrashic explanation is:

that they resembled each other in their facial features (Genesis Rabbah 41:6).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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אם השמאל ואימנה.

בְּכָל אֲשֶׁר תֵּשֵׁב, לֹא אֶתְרַחֵק מִמְּךָ וְאֶעֱמֹד לְךָ לְמָגֵן וּלְעֵזֶר, וְסוֹף דָּבָר הֶצְרֵךְ לוֹ,

אם השמאל ואימינה *IF THOU WILT TAKE THE LEFT HAND, THAN I WILL GO TO THE RIGHT —Wherever you settle down I will not go far from you and I will stand by you as a shield and as a helper.*

שְׁנֶאֱמַר וַיִּשְׁמַע אַבְרָם כִּי נִשְׁבָּה אָחִיו וְגוֹ':

Ultimately, indeed, he (Lot) was really in need of him, as it is said, (Genesis 14:14) "And Abram heard that his brother was taken captive etc."

ואימנה.

אַיְמִין אֶת עַצְמִי, כְּמוֹ וְאַשְׂמְאִילָה אַשְׂמְאִיל אֶת עַצְמִי.

וְאִם תֹּאמַר הָיָה לוֹ לִנָּקֵד וְאַיְמִינָה,

כָּךְ מָצִינוּ בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר אִם יֵשׁ לְהֵמִין (שמואל ב י"ד) וְאֵין נָקוּד לְהַיְמִין:

ואימינה *I WILL GO TO THE RIGHT — The word means "I will direct myself towards the right", just as* ואשמאילה *means "I will direct myself towards the left." If you say that it should be punctuated* ואימינה להמין *(the regular Hiphil form) I answer that in another place also we find this form, (2 Samuel 14:19)* אם יש *"none can turn to the right hand", where the punctuation is not* להימין.

כי כלה משקה.

אֶרֶץ נַחֲלֵי מַיִם:

כי כלה משקה *THAT IT WAS WELL WATERED — a land of water-streams.*

לפני שחת ה' את סדום ואת עמרה.

הָיָה אוֹתוֹ מִישׁוֹר:

לפני שחת ה' את סדום ואת עמורה *BEFORE THE LORD DESTROYED SODOM AND GOMORRAHH that land was*

כגן ה'.

לְאִילָנוֹת:

כגן ה' *LIKE THE GARDEN OF GOD in respect of trees,*

כארץ מצרים.

לַזְּרָעִים (בראשית רבה):

כארץ מצרים *LIKE THE LAND OF EGYPT in respect of seed (vegetables) (Genesis Rabbah 41:7).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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באכה צער.

עַד צֹעַר. וּמִדְרַשׁ אַגָּדָה דּוֹרְשָׁהּ לְגָנַאי,

באכה צער *means AS THOU GOEST* עד צוער *to Zoar.*

עַל שֶׁהָיוּ שְׁטוּפֵי זִמָּה בָּחַר לוֹ לוֹט בִּשְׁכוּנָתָם:

The Midrashic explanation (Horayot 10b;

Genesis Rabbah 41:7) explains it to Lot's discredit — just because they (the people of Sodom and Gomorrah) were addicted to lewdness did Lot choose their locality.

ככר.

מִישׁוֹר, כְּתַרְגּוּמוֹ:

ככר *The word means "a plain" as the Targum translates it.*

מקדם.

נָסַע מֵאֵצֶל אַבְרָם וְהָלַךְ לוֹ לְמַעֲרָבוֹ שֶׁל אַבְרָם; נִמְצָא נוֹסֵעַ מִמִּזְרָח לְמַעֲרָב.

מקדם *FROM THE EAST — He removed from Abram and went westward of Abram — consequently he travelled from the East to the West.*

וּמִדְרַשׁ אַגָּדָה הִסִּיעַ עַצְמוֹ מִקַּדְמוֹנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם;

A Midrashic explanation is:

אָמַר אִי אֶפְשִׁי לֹא בְּאַבְרָם וְלֹא בֵּאלֹקָיו:

*He wandered away from the Originator (*מקדמונו*) of the Universe, saying, "I want neither Abram nor his God" (Genesis Rabbah 41:7).*

ויאהל.

נָטָה אֳהָלִים לְרוֹעָיו וּלְמִקְנֵהוּ עַד סְדוֹם:

ויאהל *means he pitched tents for his shepherds and cattle* עד סדום *throughout the whole district extending AS FAR AS SODOM.*

ואנשי סדום רעים.

וְאַף עַל פִּי כֵן לֹא נִמְנַע לוֹט מִלִּשְׁכֹּן עִמָּהֶם.

ואנשי סדום רעים *BUT THE MEN OF SODOM WERE WICKED, and yet Lot did not refrain from living with them.*

וְרַבּוֹתֵינוּ לָמְדוּ מִכָּאן (יומא ל"ח) וְשֵׁם רְשָׁעִים יִרְקָב (משלי י'):

Our Rabbis learned from here how the text (Proverbs 10:11) "and the name of the wicked shall rot" should be applied (Yoma 38b).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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רעים.
בְּגוּפָם:

רעים *WICKED in their persons*

וחטאים.
בְּמָמוֹנָם (סנה' ק"ט):

וחטאים *AND SINNERS with their wealth (Sanhedrin 109a)*

לה' מאד.
יוֹדְעִים רִבּוֹנָם, וּמִתְכַּוְּנִים לְמָרֹד בּוֹ:

מאד לה' *BEFORE THE LORD, EXCEEDINGLY — They knew their Master and yet intentionally rebelled against Him (Sifra, Bechukotai, Section 2 2).*

אחרי הפרד לוט.
כָּל זְמַן שֶׁהָרָשָׁע עִמּוֹ הָיָה הַדִּבּוּר פּוֹרֵשׁ מִמֶּנּוּ:

אחרי הפרד לוט *AFTER LOT WAS SEPARATED FROM HIM — So long as the wicked (Lot) was with him the word of God kept away from him (i. e. God had no communion with Abraham) (Midrash Tanchuma, Vayetzei 10).*

אשר אם יוכל איש.
כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאִי אֶפְשָׁר לֶעָפָר לְהִמָּנוֹת כָּךְ זַרְעֲךָ לֹא יִמָּנֶה:

אשר אם יוכל איש *SO THAT IF A MAN IS ABLE [TO COUNT] —just as it is impossible for the dust to be counted, so, too, your seed shall not be counted.*

ממרא.
שֵׁם אָדָם:

ממרא *MAMRE — the name of a man.*

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Three words, three Torahs: Rashi on the men of Sodom

Genesis 13:13 gives Rashi four spotlight comments, and they show three different source relationships in a single verse. On 'רעים' and 'וחטאים' Rashi writes 'בגופם' and 'בממונם (ק"ט סנה')' — a tight, attributed compression of Sanhedrin 109a, where Rav Yehuda reads 'wicked' as sins of the body and 'sinners' as sins of money. But Rashi is not the first to make this move: Onkelos already split the verse the same way ('בישין בממונהון וחייבין בגויתתהון'), so Rashi's citation reaches the Talmud through the Targum's precedent — the translation had already decided the exegesis.

The frame comments show the other two modes. On 'ואנשי סדם רעים' Rashi adds a moral coda of his own — 'ואף על פי כן לא נמנע לוט מלשכון עמהם' — then pivots to aggadah: 'למדו מכאן ושם רשעים ירקב... ורבותינו' (Yoma 38b), turning Lot's address choice into a prooftext about the

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rot of the wicked's name. And on 'לה' מאד' — 'יודעים ריבונם ומתכוונים למרוד בו' — he compresses the Sifra (Bechukotai) into a single devastating line: their sin was not ignorance but knowing rebellion. Three words of Scripture; three source-moves: compression via the Targum's path, aggadic pivot, and unattributed-but-faithful Sifra paraphrase.

WORD STUDIES

Three words from the aliyah

Three words from the aliyah, each with a journey: where it is first seen, how it travels the centuries, where it lands. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; historical citations via the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language (המילון ההיסטורי מפעל). A note on method: the Comprehensive Aramaic Lexicon (cal.huc.edu) prohibits scraping, so Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria.

אָרֶץ

Klein · ארץ

f.n.

— land, country.

Jastrow · ארץ

f.

— רצץ; Ch. a. oth. dial. ארע fr. רעע to press together, stamp—from the rugged appearance of the surface after the subsidence of the waters) earth, dry land; country, land, field (opp. to town). Ex. R. s. 13 … threw dust up

BDB · אדמה

— n.f. ground, land (as tilled, Ger. bebaut? DlPr 105, but Fleisch. (MerxArchiv I, 236 f) comp. Ar. skin, as smoothly covering & close-fitting; דם cf. Ar. smear (spread over surface); cf. also NöZMG 1886, 73

Maagarim

ארץ — 39,550 attestations, root ארץ 1 (אדמה). First seen Gen 1:1; last citations in 1937 Hebrew belles-lettres — from creation to modern prose.

ארץ is first seen on the Bible's opening page — 'בראשית ברא אלקים את השמים ואת הארץ' — the undifferentiated earth of creation. Jastrow traces it to a root of pressing and ruggedness, 'from the rugged appearance of the surface after the subsidence of the waters'; BDB spreads it across Semitic (Phoenician ארץ, Akkadian irṣitu, Arabic). In our aliyah it narrows to the promised land — 'אתכלהארץ אשראתה ראה' (13:15) — and Cassuto counts ארץ seven times in the promise, the chapter's Leitwort. Maagarim's sweep gives the scale: 33,464 citations opening with Genesis 1:1 and closing, astonishingly, on one modern work — the final page belongs entirely to Yitzhak Shami's 1937 ומעה אלאהבל'ג.

אַבְרָם

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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BDB · אברם

— n.pr.m. (id., Thes al. exalted father) Abram Gn 11:26, 27 + 57 times Gn (to 17:5) + 1 Ch 1:27 Ne 9:7; = אברהם Abraham Gn 17:5, 9, 15 + 172 times OT. (אברהם connected Gn 17:5 by word-play with הם of המון; really = אבר

BDB · אברם²

— v. אבירם, אבישי sub II. אבה.

Maagarim

אברם [שם פרטי] — 218 attestations. Proper name, no root; Gen 11:26 to Mendele Moykher-Sforim (1910).

אברם — 'exalted father' (BDB: אב + רם), borne 57 times in Genesis until 17:5, when God renames him אברהם by wordplay with המון, 'multitude' — theology, not philology. In our aliyah he is still Abram, the childless elder dividing flocks with his nephew. Maagarim sharpens the poignancy: אברם is a tiny entry — 218 occurrences against אברהם's 6,282 — dense in Genesis, then it simply vanishes after chapter 17, followed by centuries of silence. The name resurfaces in Renaissance chronicles (1573, 1587) and a 19th-century Haskalah tail — Lefin (1844), Sokolow (1882), Mendele (1910) — maskilim reaching back past אברהם to the earlier, unrenamed man.

בֵּין

Klein · בין

prep.

— between, among, during.

Jastrow · בין

— , v. בוא) to pierce, split, penetrate; whence, to discern, understand; v. Hif.

Jastrow · בין ²

— ; v. infra.—Pa. ביין, בין to teach, make wise. Targ. Ps. CXIX, 27. Targ. Job XXXII, 8. Ib. v. 9 יבינון דינא explain the law (ed. Vienn. יבינון, Pe., understand).

Maagarim

בין — 41,380 attestations, root בון 4 (באמצע, באמצעות). First seen Gen 1:4 — in the exact form ובין; last citations 1937 Hebrew belles-lettres.

בין — 'between, among, during' (Klein). Jastrow uncovers the engine: the root means to pierce, split, penetrate — whence 'to discern, understand.' Between-ness is an act of cutting. In our aliyah בין does the narrative work: 'ויהיריב בין רעי מקנהאברם ובין רעי מקנהלט' (13:7) — the between of the shepherds becomes the quarrel, and Abram's remedy is to make it permanent: 'הפרד נא מעלי.' Maagarim's gem: its very first citation, Genesis 1:4 — 'ובין החשך ויבדל אלקים בין האור' — already holds our exact form ובין beside bare בין, separation doubling itself in creation's first week.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr